Tracker Plus

Easy guide for your 6-in-1 live desk display · Internet Radio, Aircraft, Ships, Sky & Space, Ticker Plus and World Events · version 1.4, build 130

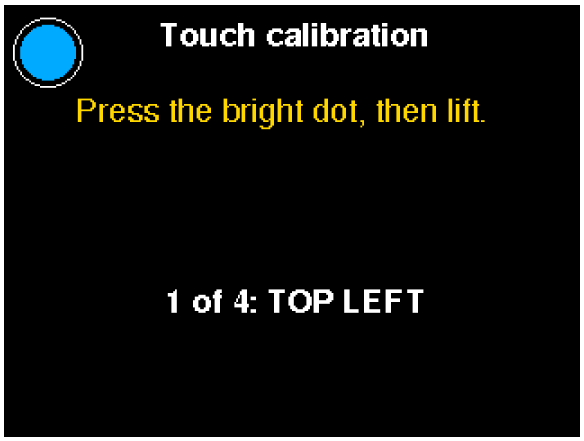
Welcome! Tracker Plus is a small touch-screen gadget for your desk. Plug it in, connect it to your Wi-Fi, and it shows live things from around the world: an internet radio, planes flying near you, ships at sea, rocket launches, the weather and world news. No subscription. Nothing to pay each month.

1. What you need

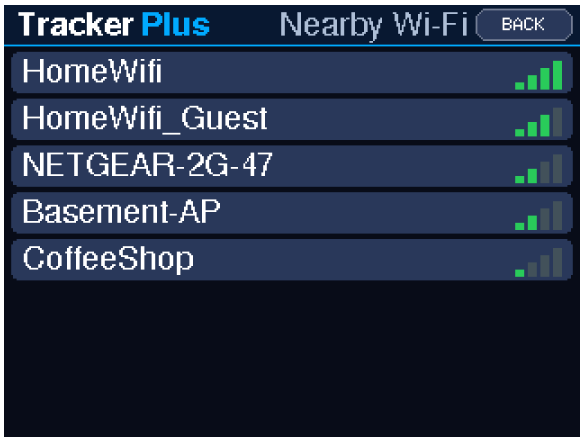
- The unit and a USB power cable (any phone charger works).
- **Your own Wi-Fi, 2.4 GHz.** Most home routers have it. It does not work on a 5 GHz-only network. If your router has both, pick the one without “5G” in its name.
- A phone, for two optional things: adding the free ship key, and adding your own radio stations.
- Radio and alert sounds play through the unit's small speaker. If yours came without the speaker, everything else works but it stays silent.

2. First start: 4 easy steps

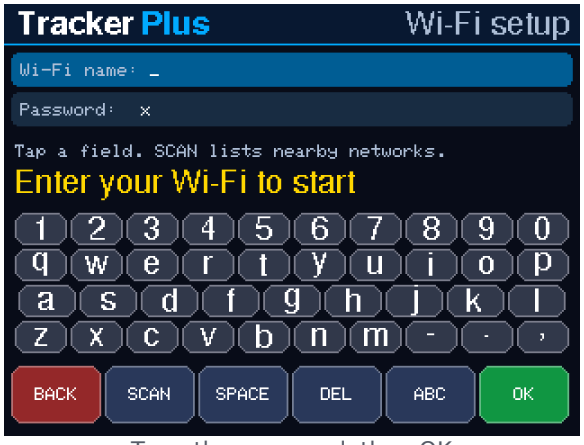
1. **Plug it in.** The screen lights up.
2. **Touch the dots.** Four dots appear one at a time: top left, top right, the middle, then the bottom. Press the middle of each dot with your fingertip, then lift. This teaches the screen where your finger is.
3. **Join your Wi-Fi.** Tap SCAN, tap your network's name in the list, type the password, then tap OK. The unit remembers it.
4. **Set your town.** Tap Settings, then Location, and type your town. This gives you the right weather, sky and plane radar for where you live.



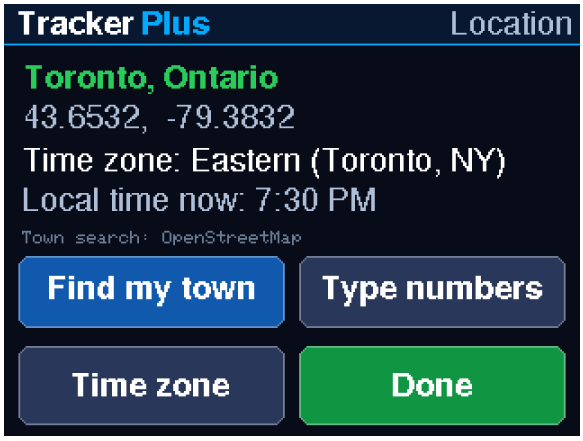
Step 2: touch each dot



Step 3: tap your Wi-Fi name



Type the password, then OK

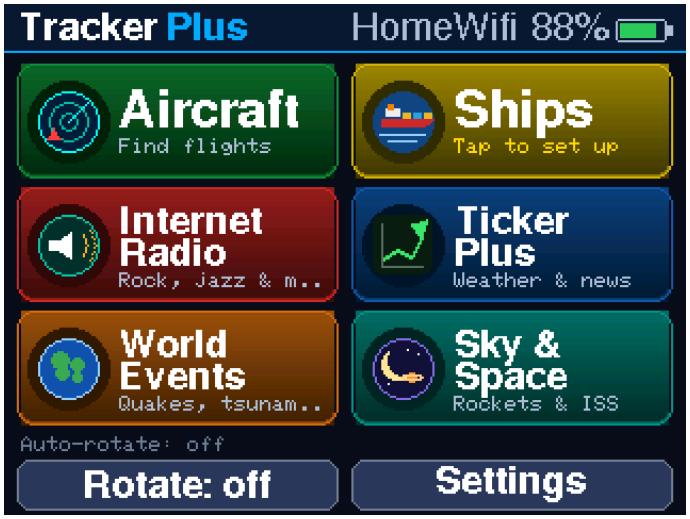


Step 4: type your town

Tip: if a tap lands in the wrong place, hold your finger on the screen for 3 seconds on the Wi-Fi screen, or go to Settings and tap Cal, to touch the dots again.

3. The Home screen

This is where you start. Tap a coloured tile to open that app.



Home: six tiles, plus Rotate and Settings at the bottom

- **Top right:** your Wi-Fi name and, if your unit has a battery, the battery level. A lightning bolt means it is charging. Units without a battery show nothing there. That is normal.
- **Only one app runs at a time.** When you open another one, the unit restarts quietly for 3 to 5 seconds. That is on purpose, so every app gets all the memory.
- **Please be patient.** Each time an app opens it downloads fresh information, so give it a few seconds.
- **To come back Home:** in every app, tap the blue **HOME** button at the top right. Most apps also have a **MENU** button next to it for that app's own choices.
- **Rotate:** turns auto-rotate on or off (see Settings below).

4. The six apps, in plain words

Aircraft Radar

What is it? A live radar of the planes flying around your home, within about 46 miles (40 nautical miles). Each little plane points the way it is flying. Tap one to see its flight number, type of aircraft, height, speed and how far away it is.



FIND: look up a flight

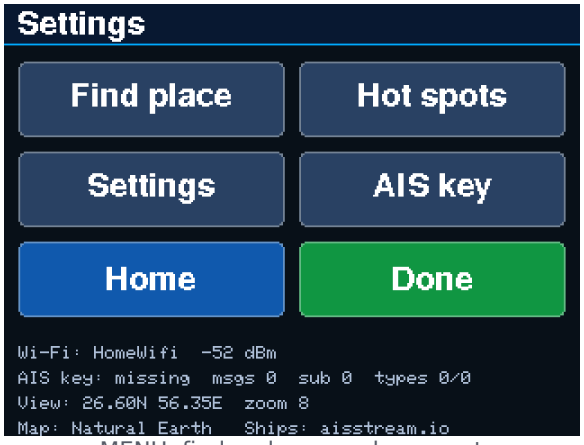


Planes around you, live

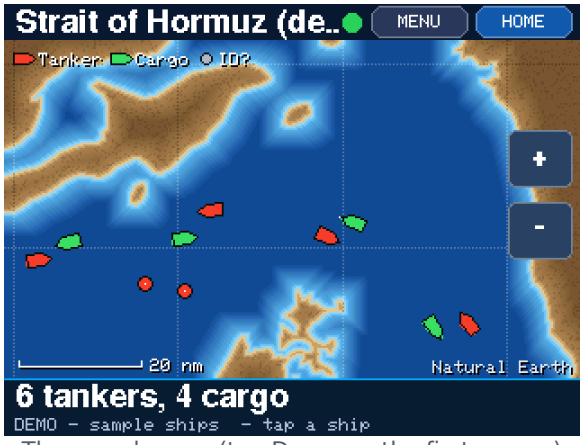
Tap **FIND** to look up a flight by name. **ALERTS** shows emergencies anywhere in the world. **HOME** goes back to the Home screen. A red **SOS!** appears if a plane is sending an emergency signal. Tap **Next** to step through the planes.

Ship Tracker

What is it? A live sea map showing tankers (red) and cargo ships (green) as they sail. Tap a ship to see its name. Use the - and + buttons on the right of the map to zoom. Tap MENU, then Find place or Hot spots, to jump to a famous port or strait.



MENU: find a place or a busy spot

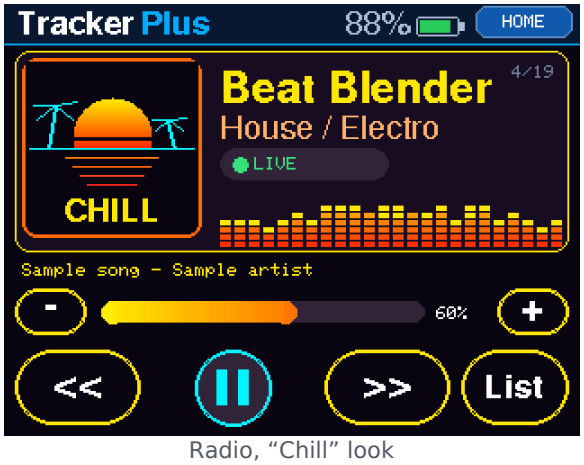


The sample map (tap Demo on the first screen)

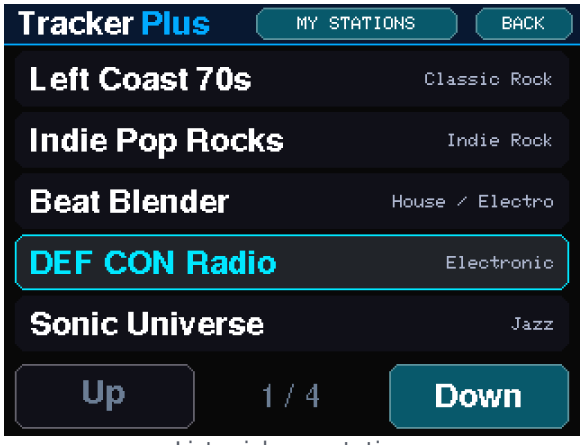
One-time setup (free): ships need a free key from aisstream.io. The first time, the unit shows a QR code. Scan it with your phone, sign up (free), copy the key and paste it in. Done for ever. Want a look first? Tap **Demo**. New ships show as grey dots at first, then turn red or green after a few minutes. That is normal.

Internet Radio

Plays radio stations over the internet. 19 are built in (music, jazz, classical and more). Tap the big buttons: back, pause, forward, and List to pick a station. Volume is the small - and + buttons. Tap the picture to change the look. There are 6 looks to choose from.



Radio, “Chill” look



List: pick any station

> **What does it sound like?** Honestly, comparable to an AM radio. It is warm and simple, and the quality is decent. It is not a hi-fi stereo. That is the charm of it.

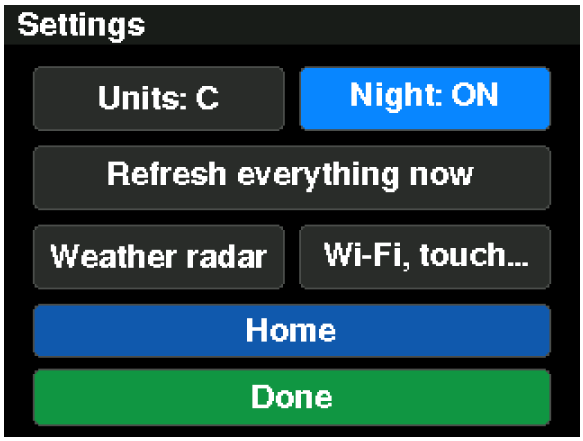
Add your own stations: in the radio tap List, then MY STATIONS, scan the QR code with your phone, and type up to 3 stations of your own. Or put a file called STATIONS.TXT on an SD card (up to 50 stations). Stations must start with **http://** (not https). The Internet Radio FAQ shows how.

Ticker Plus

A desk clock that also shows the weather, today's exchange rates, news headlines, “On this day”, the moon, sunrise and sunset, weather warnings and air quality. Tap the weather card to see the weather radar. Tap MENU (top right) for: Units (C or F), Night clock, Refresh everything now, Weather radar, Home.



Clock, weather and news



The MENU

Night clock: at night the screen goes to a dim clock after a minute of no touching. Tap to wake it. Turn it off in the MENU if you do not want it.

World Events

Big news as it happens. Pages: **Quakes** (magnitude 7 and up), **Tsunami** messages, **Disasters** (storms, floods, eruptions) and **World news**. Tap any item for more detail and a QR code to read the full story on your phone. A card with a sound pops up for a major new event; tap it to close.



Big earthquakes



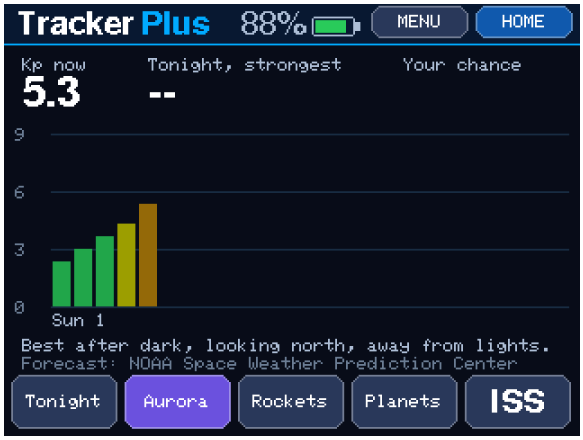
Tap an item: detail + QR code

Sky & Space

What is happening above you. Five pages across the bottom: **Tonight** (what to look for), **Aurora** (the northern lights chance, 3 days ahead), **Rockets** (launch countdowns; tap one for details and a “Play liftoff” animation), **Planets**, and **ISS** (when the space station passes over you). It can pop up an alert for a launch, an aurora or an ISS pass.

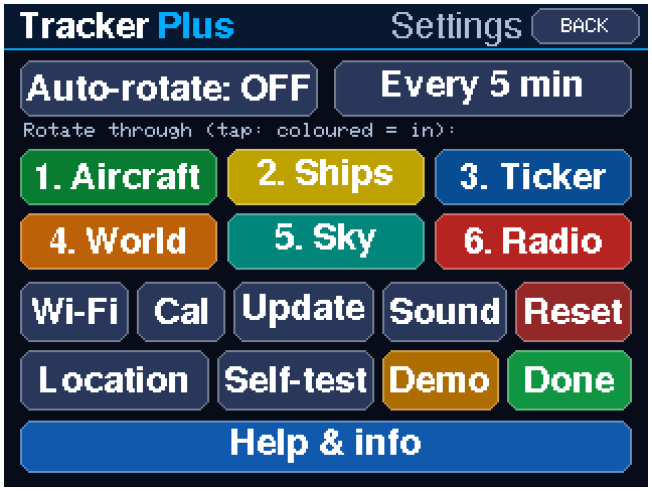


Rocket launch countdowns



Aurora chance

5. Settings, button by button



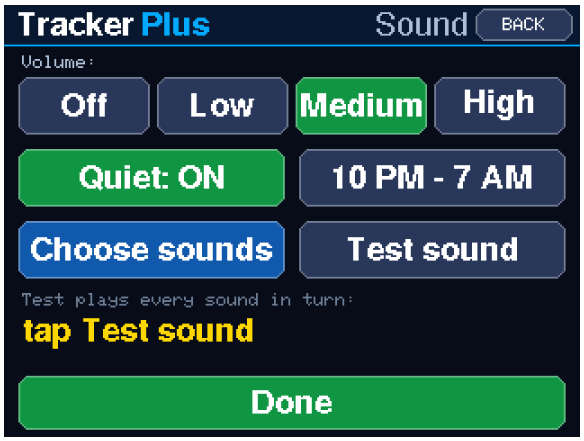
Home, then Settings

- **Auto-rotate ON/OFF** and **Every N min:** the unit moves to the next app by itself (every 2, 5, 10, 15 or 30 minutes).

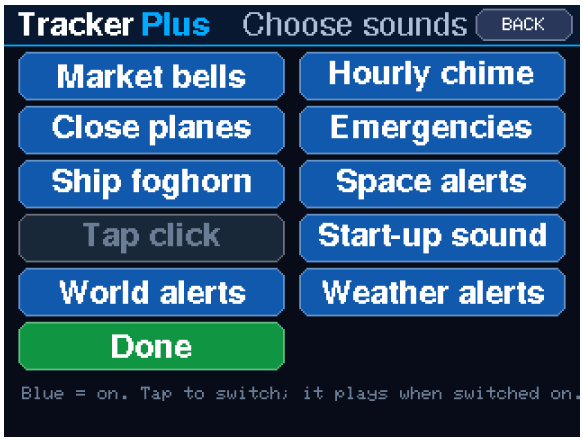
- **Rotate through:** choose which apps take part. They are numbered 1 Aircraft, 2 Ships, 3 Ticker, 4 World, 5 Sky and 6 Radio, and the unit moves through them in that order.
- **Wi-Fi:** pick a different network. Saved networks are remembered.
- **Cal:** touch the four dots again.
- **Update:** installs the newest software over Wi-Fi (see section 7).
- **Sound:** see section 6.
- **Reset:** erases everything you typed (see section 8).
- **Location:** your town and time zone.
- **Self-test:** checks every internet source and shows PASS or FAIL.
- **Demo:** shows the apps with sample data. **Done:** back. **Help & info:** scan the QR code for this guide and the FAQs.

6. Sound

Settings > Sound. Choose the volume (Off, Low, Medium, High). **Quiet hours** keeps the unit silent at night (for example 10 PM to 7 AM). **Choose sounds** switches each sound on or off: market bells, hourly chime, close planes, emergencies, ship foghorn, space alerts, tap click, start-up sound, world alerts and weather alerts. **Test sound** plays them. The radio volume is the - and + buttons inside the radio.



Volume and quiet hours



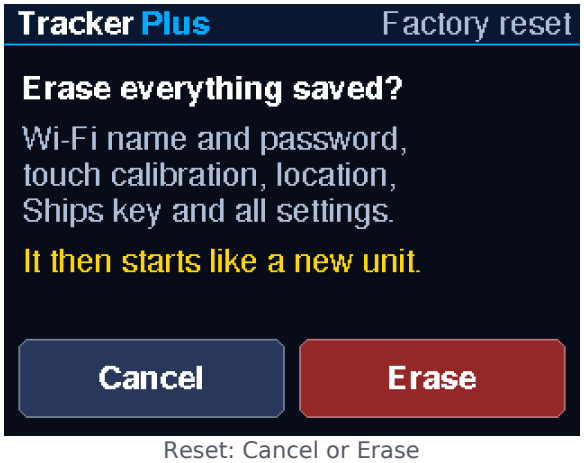
Pick the sounds you want

7. Updates

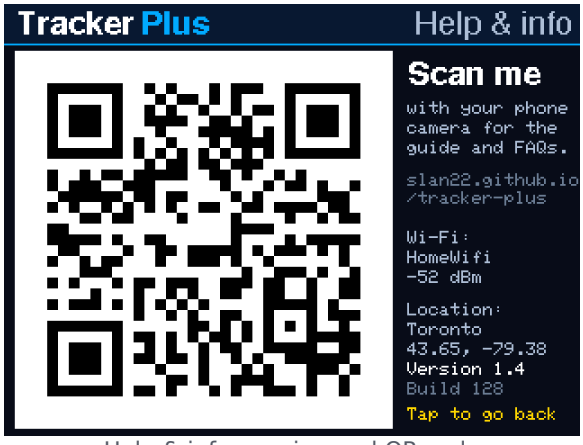
We send improvements over Wi-Fi. Go to **Settings > Update**. If a new version is there, tap **Install**. It takes about a minute, restarts, and keeps your Wi-Fi and settings. Do not unplug it while it installs.

8. Starting again (Reset)

Settings > Reset > Erase wipes your Wi-Fi, touch settings, town, ship key and settings, like a brand new unit. Use it if you give the unit to someone else.



Reset: Cancel or Erase



Help & info: version and QR code

9. Something is not working?

The screen does not react where I touch.

Settings > Cal, and press the middle of each dot. Press the dots carefully, in the exact middle.

An app is empty or says Loading.

Wait a minute. Then Settings > Self-test and see which line says FAIL. Check your Wi-Fi is 2.4 GHz and the signal is good (Help & info shows it).

It cannot join my Wi-Fi.

It needs 2.4 GHz. Check the password (capital letters count). Move the unit closer to the router.

No sound.

Check Settings > Sound is not Off or in Quiet hours. In the radio, press + for volume. Units without a speaker have no sound.

Ships shows only grey dots.

Normal for the first 5 to 10 minutes. Try MENU > Hot spots to go where ships are busy.

The weather or my town is wrong.

Settings > Location, and set your town again.

The battery shows nothing.

Your unit has no battery. It works fine on USB power.

Still stuck?

Contact the seller and tell them the version number shown in Settings > Help & info.

Aircraft, ships, news, weather and other live data come from free third-party services. Their availability, speed and accuracy can change at any time, so live data features cannot be guaranteed.